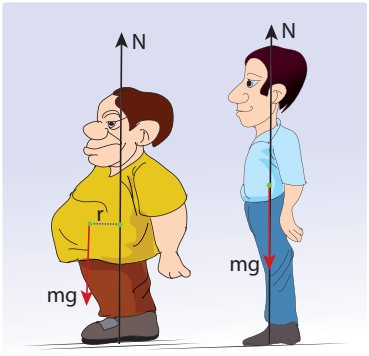
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Obesity, torque and Moment of Inertia!



Obesity and associated ailments like back pain, joint pain etc. are due to the shift in center of mass of the body. Due to this shift in center of mass, unbalanced torque acting on the body leads to ailments. As the mass is spread away from center of the body the moment of inertia is more and turning will also be difficult.

5.4.5 Theorems of Moment of Inertia

As the moment of inertia depends on the axis of rotation and also the orientation of the body about that axis, it is different for the same body with different axes of rotation. We have two important theorems to handle the case of shifting the axis of rotation.

(i) Parallel axis theorem:

Parallel axis theorem states that the moment of inertia of a body about any axis is equal to the sum of its moment of inertia about a parallel axis through its center of mass and the product of the mass of the body and the square of the perpendicular distance between the two axes.

If I_C is the moment of inertia of the body of mass M about an axis passing through the center of mass, then the moment of inertia I about a parallel axis at a distance d from it is given by the relation,

$$I = I_C + Md^2 \qquad (5.46)$$

Let us consider a rigid body as shown in Figure 5.25. Its moment of inertia about an axis AB passing through the center of mass is I_C. DE is another axis parallel to AB at a perpendicular distance d from AB. The moment of inertia of the body about DE is I. We attempt to get an expression for I in terms of I_C. For this, let us consider a point mass m on the body at position x from its center of mass.

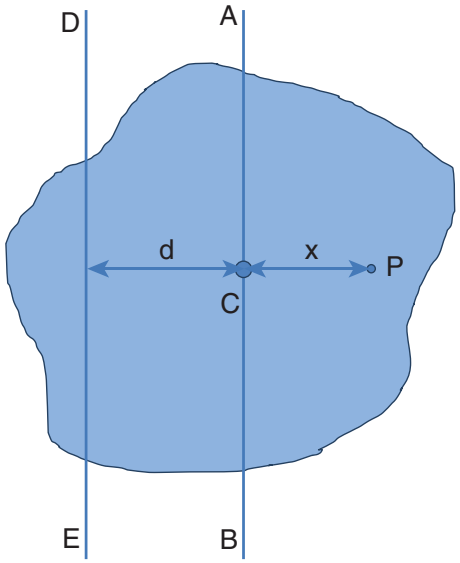


Figure 5.25 Parallel axis theorem

The moment of inertia of the point mass about the axis DE is, $m(x+d)^2$.

The moment of inertia I of the whole body about DE is the summation of the above expression.

$$I = \sum m(x+d)^2$$